



The LeaderReps Accountability System Blueprint

The Blueprint

Strong teams have strong accountability systems.

When expectations are clear, work outcomes are correct. When handoffs are clean, ownership sticks. When follow-up is consistent, priorities stay visible. When feedback is timely, performance improves.

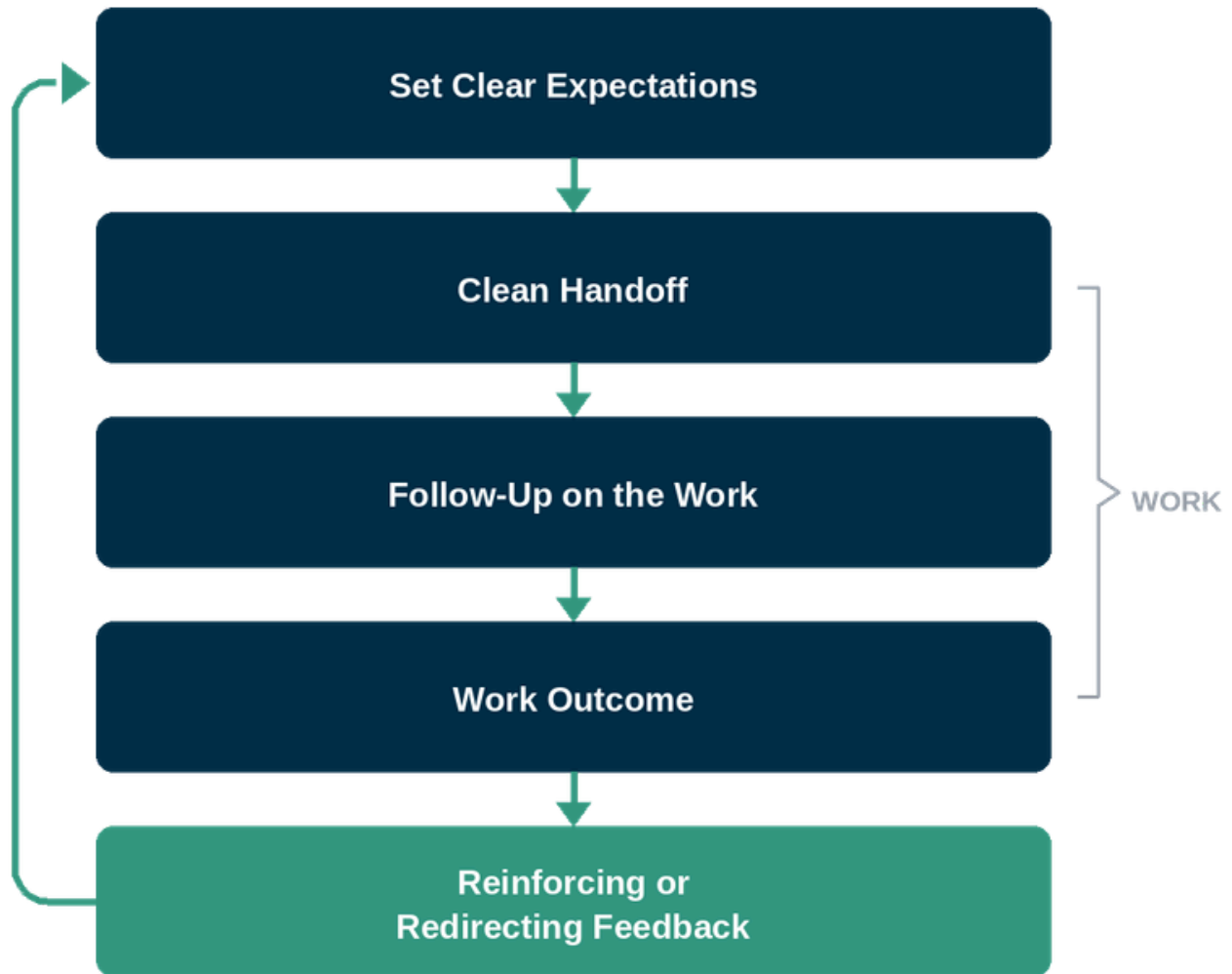
This blueprint includes a map of a high-functioning accountability system and the four behavior reps at its core — and shows you how to run each one. Inside, you'll find the specific reps that, when practiced consistently, give your team clarity and ownership.

THE REPS

- Set Clear Expectations with a Clean Handoff
- Follow-Up on the Work
- Deliver Reinforcing Feedback
- Deliver Redirecting Feedback

Use the blueprint as a reference. Share it with your managers. Come back to it if things get inconsistent or need a tune-up.

The Accountability System



Rep 1: Set Clear Expectations with a Clean Handoff

Define the work clearly, define what success looks like, and ensure ownership of the outcome is unmistakably clear.

Clear expectations eliminate ambiguity before execution begins.

THE 4 MOVES

01 Define the Work

State the task, responsibility, or behavioral standard clearly.

"Prepare a three-slide summary of the client risks." "If a deadline might slip, flag it early."

02 Define What "Done" Looks Like

Clarify what success looks like when the work is complete.

"Include the three main risks and the actions you recommend."

03 Confirm Shared Understanding

Ensure both people interpret the expectation the same way.

"To make sure I didn't forget anything, what's your understanding of the assignment?"

04 Clean Handoff (Ownership)

Confirm who owns the outcome.

"You'll own the client update and send it Thursday afternoon."

GUARDRAIL

Never assign work without defining what "done" looks like.

Leader: *"Send the client update."*

Problem: **Success was never defined.**

Clear expectations define the **outcome**, not the process.

REP RECOGNITION

You're likely in an SCE moment when:

- Assigning work to someone
- Delegating ownership of a responsibility
- Clarifying how work should be done
- Resetting expectations that drifted

"Can you..."

"I need you to..."

"Going forward..."

Key Distinction: Clear Expectations define the work. Clean Handoff transfers ownership. You can have clarity without ownership — and that's a problem.

STRONG REP EXAMPLE – DELIVERABLE

LEADER	"Please prepare a three-slide summary of the client risks."	DEFINE WORK
	"Include the three main risks and recommended actions."	DEFINE DONE
	"Send it by Thursday afternoon."	
	"So we're aligned — what's your understanding of the task?"	CONFIRM
	"Will you take ownership of this?"	THE ASK
DIRECT	"Three slides with the risks and actions by Thursday. I'll take care of it."	ACCEPTANCE

RESULT The work is clear, success is defined, and ownership is unmistakable.

WHY THIS WORKS

- The work is clearly defined — no guessing what's expected
- Success criteria are inspectable — both people can evaluate the result
- Understanding is confirmed — alignment exists before execution begins
- Ownership is unmistakable — one person is responsible for the outcome

STRONG REP EXAMPLE – BEHAVIORAL STANDARD

LEADER	"If a deadline might slip, flag it early. Bring me several options for what can be done to catch up."	DEFINE WORK	
	"That way, we can work together to hit the deadline — or manage expectations if we're going to miss it."	DEFINE DONE	
DIRECT	"Got it — flag it early and bring options."	CONFIRM	ACCEPTANCE

RESULT The behavior standard is clear, success is visible in execution, and alignment is confirmed.

SIGNS YOU'RE GETTING STRONGER

- Fewer projects require clarification after they begin
- Team members can describe outcomes clearly when asked
- Work product arrives closer to what you expected
- Accountability conversations become easier

Rep 2: Follow-Up on the Work

Check in on work while it's still in progress, not after the deadline. Strong follow-up creates execution visibility without taking the work back or stepping on ownership.

THE 3 MOVES

01

Ask for Status

Anchor the question to the work directly — not to how the person feels about it.

"Where are you with the client proposal?"
"Are we still on track for Thursday?"

02

Validate Progress

If the response sounds like reassurance, ask one more question to reveal real execution progress.

"What's left to finish?"
"What tells you you're on track?"

03

Check for Obstacles

Once progress is clear, surface risks. Then leave ownership with the direct.

"Anything getting in the way?"
"What might slow this down?"

GUARDRAIL

Don't follow up with "How's it going?"

Always anchor the question to the work.

Weak: *"How's it going?"*

Creates the reassurance loop — no real visibility.

Strong: *"Where are you with the proposal?"*

Anchored to the work. Requires a real answer.

REP RECOGNITION

You're in an FUW moment when:

- A deadline is approaching and you haven't heard an update
- A project is underway and progress is unclear
- Work was recently delegated
- You hear reassurance but not specifics
- You want to surface risks before they become problems

Follow-up inspects progress. It does not correct behavior. It does not take the work back.

STRONG REP EXAMPLE

LEADER "Where are you with the client proposal?"

ASK FOR STATUS

DIRECT "I've finished the first section and I'm working on the rest."

LEADER "What's left to finish?"

VALIDATE

DIRECT "The pricing analysis and final review."

LEADER "Anything getting in the way?"

CHECK FOR OBSTACLES

DIRECT "I'm waiting on updated numbers from finance."

LEADER "What's your next step once you have those?"

LEAVE OWNERSHIP

RESULT Progress is visible, an obstacle surfaced early, and ownership stays with the direct.

WHY THIS WORKS

- The work is clearly referenced — not a vague check-in
- Real progress becomes visible — not just reassurance
- An obstacle is surfaced before it became a problem
- Ownership remained with the direct throughout

COMMON PITFALL — THE REASSURANCE LOOP

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

LEADER "How's the project going?"

DIRECT "Pretty well."

LEADER "Great. Let me know if you need anything"

No visibility into progress. The leader accepted reassurance instead of inspecting work.

Strong follow-up requires one additional move: **validate the progress**. Ask what's left, what the next milestone is, or what part of the work remains.

SIGNS YOU'RE GETTING STRONGER

- People explain the stage of their work clearly without prompting
- Risks surface earlier in projects
- Your team comes prepared with progress updates
- You feel less pressure to step in and fix work yourself

Rep 3: Deliver Reinforcing Feedback

Notice a specific behavior, explain why it matters, and reinforce that the behavior should continue. Reinforcing feedback teaches people what good looks like — and helps strong behaviors repeat.

THE MOVE – EAR

E

Evidence / Explain the Behavior

Name the specific, observable behavior you noticed.

"You summarized the client's concerns before proposing a solution."

A

Anchor the Impact

Explain why the behavior matters — connect it to results, the team, or culture.

"That helped the team align quickly."

R

Reinforce the Behavior

Signal clearly that the behavior should continue.

"Thank you. Please keep doing that."

GUARDRAIL

Don't reinforce behavior without naming the behavior.

Leader: *"Great job today."*

Problem: No behavior was identified. The person doesn't know what to repeat.

Generic praise feels good in the moment. It does not build the behavior.

REP RECOGNITION

You're in a DRF moment when a direct:

- Demonstrates a behavior you want repeated
- Improves after prior feedback
- Follows through strongly on a responsibility
- Takes ownership without prompting

If you think *"I wish everyone on the team did that,"* you're in a reinforcing feedback moment.

Reinforcing feedback is not praise. It names a behavior, explains why it matters, and signals that it should continue.

STRONG REP EXAMPLE

LEADER

"You summarized the client's concerns before proposing a solution."

EVIDENCE /
EXPLAIN

"That helped the team align quickly and kept the conversation focused."

ANCHOR

"Thank you. Please keep doing that."

REINFORCE

RESULT

The behavior is clear, the impact is understood, and the standard for the team becomes visible.

WHY THIS WORKS

- The behavior is observable — it passes the camera test
- The impact is explicit — the person understands why it matters
- The direction is clear — the person knows to repeat it
- The team standard becomes visible — others learn what good looks like

THE CAMERA TEST

THE BEHAVIOR YOU REINFORCE SHOULD PASS THE CAMERA TEST

If a camera recorded the moment, a neutral observer should be able to see the behavior occurring.

STRONG — OBSERVABLE

"You summarized the client's concerns before proposing a solution."

WEAK — TRAIT-BASED

"You showed great leadership."

If the behavior isn't observable, the person cannot easily repeat it. The Camera Test moves leaders from generic praise to behavioral reinforcement.

SIGNS YOU'RE GETTING STRONGER

- You notice positive behaviors more quickly
- Reinforcing feedback becomes natural and frequent
- Team members repeat positive behaviors more consistently
- Your culture becomes more visibly aligned around what good looks like

Rep 4: Deliver Redirecting Feedback

Correct observable behavior directly so the standard is clear and the next action is known. Done well, Redirecting Feedback strengthens trust because expectations become clear.

THE CLEAR FRAMEWORK

C

Check First

Make sure they are open to receiving feedback.

"Do you have time for some feedback?"

L

Label Intent

Name the intent of the feedback and why you're giving it.

"I have some redirecting feedback from yesterday's client call..."

E

Evidence - Explain the Behavior

Name the specific, observable behavior. Use the camera test.

"You interrupted the client twice before they finished speaking."

A

Anchor the Impact

Connect the behavior to impact, results, standards, or the team.

"That made it harder for them to explain the issue fully."

R

Request

Make the direction explicit. Define the change.

"Going forward, let them finish before responding."

REQUEST TYPES — ALL MUST LAND IN CLARITY

01 — COMMAND

Direct Instruction

You define the behavior. Use when standards are clear or behavior must change immediately.

02 — CHALLENGE

Prompt Ownership

You ask them to define the change — then confirm the answer explicitly.

03 — COLLABORATE

Co-Create the Solution

You work through it together — then define the final behavior clearly.

Regardless of type, the final behavior request must be explicit.

GUARDRAILS

Camera Test

If a camera can't capture it, don't say it.
Observable behavior only.

Explicit Request Required

No defined future behavior → no real feedback. The rep is incomplete.

Composure Always

Never deliver redirecting feedback when angry.

No Mixed Feedback

Don't combine praise and correction (aka a sh!t sandwich). It softens the signal.

REP RECOGNITION

You're in a RED moment when:

- A behavior gap is clear
- Something didn't meet the standard
- You feel tension or hesitation about addressing it
- The same issue is repeating
- You're tempted to let it slide

If behavior needs to change → this is RED.

STRONG REP EXAMPLE

LEADER

"Do you have a minute for some redirecting feedback?"
"In today's meeting, you interrupted the client twice before they finished speaking."
"That made it harder for them to explain the issue fully, and required us to go back and re-ask the questions."
"Going forward, let them finish before responding."

CHECK / LABEL

EVIDENCE /
EXPLAIN

ANCHOR

REQUEST

RESULT

The behavior is named, the impact is clear, and the expectation for next time is explicit.

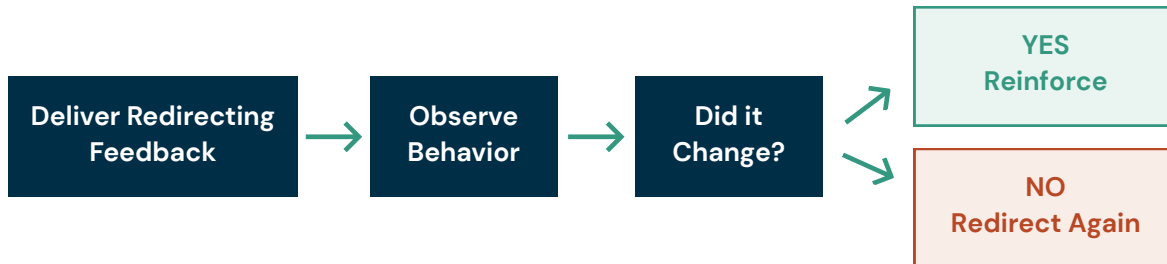
WHY THIS WORKS

- The behavior is observable — it passes the camera test
- The impact is explicit — the person understands why it matters
- The expectation is defined — no ambiguity about what changes next time
- Delivery is direct and composed — no softening, no mixing, no hedging

CLOSE THE LOOP

Redirecting Feedback is not complete until the behavior changes.

After delivering RED, observe what happens next and follow up accordingly.



Accountability is a loop, not a moment.

SIGNS YOU'RE GETTING STRONGER

- You address issues sooner instead of avoiding them
- Your language becomes more specific and observational
- Expectations are clear from the beginning
- People adjust behavior more quickly
- Difficult conversations feel more controlled and less emotional